

THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

PAYSON, ARIZONA · MIDDAS, THE 7TH OF FROSTFALL (WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 7, 2026) · MORNING EDITION — VOL. 2610, No. 07
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Gandy basks half-asleep in the sun while Maevy hunts a butterfly.

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

84° / 58°

Mostly Sunny

Sunrise 6:24 AM · Sunset 6:01 PM

Tomorrow — Mostly sunny, 84/60

OVERHEARD LAST NIGHT

A trapper swears the elk at Green Valley Park has taken to directing the wagon parade with his antlers like a marshal's batons. The barkeep only shrugged: "Aye — Earl takes his pageantry serious."

THE MOON'S RECKONING



Yesterday Tonight Tomorrow

Waning Crescent

waning toward the new moon

7th of Frostfall = October 7

Months run one-for-one all year

Sundas=Sun ... Loredas=Sat

AROUND THE HOLDS · THE WEEK AHEAD

Wagons in Payson, Homecoming in the Verde



Payson, Ariz.

PAYSON — Hail, friend of the Hearth, and a bright Middas morning to you: the sun is out in force over the Rim and the Holds are stirring like a mead hall before a wedding. This weekend Payson rolls



Wagons roll and banners fly — the car show in Payson and the homecoming in the Verde, as our staff engraver imagines them.

out the grand old wagons for the 33rd annual Beeline Cruise-In, while Camp Verde throws open its gates for the 70th Fort Verde Days homecoming. Inside: the week's doings, the torches' progress, a pie worth crossing the Hold for, and the curious business of Earl's shade parlor.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY

• Payson

— **Breakfast Club: Tonto Search & Rescue** — 7:30 AM at Noley's – Books, Art & Whatnot

— **Mobile Business Services** — the AZ Secretary of State's business-filings & notary roadshow, 9 AM–3 PM at the Payson Public Library (328 N McLane Rd)

• Sedona

— **Queen Budapest** — a global cinema event at the Sedona International Film Festival, running Oct. 7–10
— **Gong Meditation** — 5:30 PM at 431 AZ-179, Ste A7

• Prescott

— **Coffee with a Cop** — 9 AM at The Porch
— **Brit Floyd** — 7 PM at the Findlay Toyota Center, Prescott Valley
— **Musicians with Heart Open Mic** — 7 PM at the Jersey Lilly

THE DAYS AHEAD

• Thu, Oct. 8

— **Rumsey Park Battle** — the weekly disc-golf league round, 4:15–6:30 PM at the Rumsey Park disc golf course in Payson. Bring discs and join the regulars; newcomers welcome.

• **Fri, Oct. 9**

— **33rd Annual Beeline Cruise-In** — Friday's program: the town cruise rolling out of Rumsey Park at 3:30 PM (registration 12–4:30 PM), followed by the Burger Burn at 4:30 PM. Free for spectators.

• **Sat, Oct. 10**

— **33rd Annual Beeline Cruise-In Car Show** — classic cars, trucks, rat rods & low riders on the grass at Green Valley Park, 8 AM–3 PM, with raffles raising coin for local charities; free to the public.

— **70th Annual Fort Verde Days** — Camp Verde's homecoming: the parade rolls down Main Street at 10 AM with Bob Weir as grand marshal, then a full festival 11 AM–7 PM with food and craft vendors, live music, artillery demonstrations, and living history at the fort; free fort entry 10 AM–4 PM.

— **35th Annual Sedona Arts Festival** — two days of juried art, live music, and good food at Sedona Red Rock High School, 9 AM–5 PM; a \$15 pass covers both days.

• **Sun, Oct. 11**

— **Fort Verde Days, Day Two** — the homecoming continues 11 AM–4 PM, with the Little Britches & Little Petticoats frontier-costume contest at 11 AM in the seating tent on Community Field.

• **Mon, Oct. 12**

— **Open Mic Night: Music with a Purpose** — songs, stories, and pints at THAT Brewery & Pub in Pine, 4–7 PM; all tips benefit the Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction crew.

• **Tue, Oct. 13**

— **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — help the Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction crew clear brush and shape new trails off Highway 87, 7 AM–noon. Bring water, gloves, and sturdy shoes; no experience needed.

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH**Quests awaiting:**

- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Due Saturday — paint the sconces faux wrought iron or wood, then UV-seal them for sun protection before they go up.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue — print two torch bodies plus the socket test piece and test-fit everything.
- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue — measure the flame bulb and socket, then design the wall mount.

Due Saturday: the torches want hanging — print them, paint them, seal them, and up they go before the weekend.



Torch sconces on the bench — painted, sealed, and nearly ready to hang.

WORD FROM THE PAYSON HOLD

The **Payson Town Council** meets next on **Wednesday, Oct. 14, at 4 PM** in the Council Chambers at Town Hall, 303 N Beeline Highway. The agenda posts at least 24 hours ahead on the Town's website — no headline items had been published as of this morning's check.

Agendas, minutes, and the recorded stream live on the Town's [Council meetings page](#).

MERCHANT OF THE HOLD

Beeline Cafe · Payson



Pie raised high — the Beeline's apple pie is held to be Arizona's finest.

A true Rim Country roadside diner serving breakfast and lunch daily. The griddle turns out chicken-fried steak and eggs, biscuits and gravy, cinnamon-roll French toast, and a Friday fish fry — but the dish travelers speak of in hushed tones is the apple pie: flaky, warmly spiced, and held by many to be the finest in all of Arizona (regulars insist a small kitchen spell is involved). A cash-only, come-hungry kind of place.

“Hands Down, the BEST Apple Pie in Arizona (and Beyond!) is at The Beeline Cafe!” — a [Wanderlog review](#)

815 S Beeline Hwy, Payson, AZ 85541
· daily 5 AM–3 PM · (928) 474-9960 ·
inexpensive · good-to-know: cash only

Why the Hearth sends you: The Hearth sends you here for the pie travelers write home about — served up with old-Payson warmth at a diner that feels like it has always been there.

TALES FROM THE TREELINE

EARL'S SHADE PARLOR



One pinecone buys a seat in the coolest shadow in the Hold.

Middas dawned hot — the pines hummed and the porch boards popped like knuckles. By noon, Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) had opened Earl's Shade Parlor: one pinecone buys a seat on the picnic blanket in Earl's (an elk) long, cool shadow. Earl stood very straight and pretended the scheme was his idea. Henny (a chicken) claimed the front seat like she'd reserved weeks ago.

Business was brisk. But shadows, as Mabel (a wood elf) noted over her basket of basil, are notorious wanderers. By one o'clock the blanket sat in blazing sun, with Henny glaring at it. “New location!” Jethro announced, hauling blanket, basket, and chicken twenty paces east to the shadow's new address. By three, half the clearing trailed Earl in a solemn procession, picnicking in motion, and Henny rode the blanket like a raft, declaring it “shadow-surfing.”

Earl accepted two red apples as tribute and stood a little straighter. Nobody has ever seen him prouder.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Middas be free of dragons, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉